

back between applications (return to the Home screen and then “go back” to the previously-used application), close an open virtual keyboard, menu, dialog or search experience, navigate to a previous page and more. This button, completely absent on the iPhone, is probably one of Windows Phone’s best features. There’s also a standalone hardware-based camera button with additional capabilities like full press and half press for launching, auto-focusing and clicking photos. There are the volume buttons and a power button which also can, with a half press and full press, dim the screen, wake the device etc.



HTC Phone 7 Mozart has an 8MP camera

- ▶ **Camera:** While smartphone cameras haven’t quite caught up to dedicated digital cameras from a quality perspective, your Windows Phone should come pretty close. Microsoft mandates that the phone manufacturers include a minimum 5 MP camera accompanied with flash. You can already find devices that exceed these requirements. The Windows Phone camera must take pictures with an aspect ratio of 4:3, which is non-widescreen. Some phone makers offer enhanced cameras with 16:9 or 16:10 widescreen photo (and video) capabilities. Some even ship devices with a second, front-mounted camera for video conferencing. Note, however, that this second camera is not natively supported by the Windows Phone OS, so the phone maker will need to ship special software for that purpose.

- ▶ **Capacitive multi-touch display:** Similar to most other smartphones these days, Windows Phones are primarily multi-touch based devices which come with software-based keyboards, or Soft Input Panels (SIPs), that work in portrait and landscape modes. The different screens on the phone have features using both, touch and multi-touch, with as many as four contact points. That means you could theoretically place four fingers on the screen. Hardware makers are free to optionally